



EPISODE SIX

MASTER KNOT

SLOANE. SILAS. RENN.

THREADS REMEMBER.
KNOTS DECIDE.

THE WEFTBOUND

FREIGHTER, GLIDING CLASS
CAPTAIN: MAMA VEX

FALLING CITY
ABOVE—!

VANGUARD BLOCKADE
BELOW—!!

LOOKOUT
POST, KITE!

ON IT!

KITE

AGE: 8
ORPHAN, FEARLESS

NOT TODAY,
YOU BRASS-PLATED
BASTARDS!

KLANG!!

HOLD THE LINE,
POGO. I NEED
THOSE ENGINES
BREATHING.

I-I CAN'T—!
THE WEFT-FLOW
IS SPIKING—!

MAMA VEX

AGE: 50
CAPTAIN, PROTECTOR.
RULE: FAMILY FIRST.

RENN

AGE: 16
CLIMBER, HELMSMAN.
WEFT-TOUCHED.

POGO

AGE: 15
MECHANIC, GENIUS.
PARANOID (RIGHTLY).

STARBOARD
ENGINE FLUTTERING!

PRESSURE DROP
IN THE WEFT-LINES!

HOLDFASTS
THREE AND FIVE
SNAPPED!

IF I OVERCLOCK
THE BYPASS—

—WE BURN OUT!

IF I DON'T—

WE FALL!

RENN!

INCOMING!

BOOM!

BOOM!

**VANGUARD
IRONCLADS!**

FULL BROADSIDE—!

THEY CAN'T
CATCH WHAT THEY
CAN'T CLIMB TO!
❤️



YOU SURE
THIS IS THE
WAY?!

THERE'S NO
OTHER WAY
DOWN!

THEN
HOLD ON
TIGHT!

R-RENN!
WAIT!

FOCUS.

WHOOOOSH



The Anchor's
hollow doesn't
forgive the
hesitant.



TICK-
TICK-
TICK-

Only the
relentless
survive the
descent.

DEPTHS OF THE ANCHOR

- 3,142 FATHOMS BELOW -

ONCE, THIS ANCHOR
HELD FAST AGAINST
THE GREAT CURRENT.

NOW, IT RUSTS.
IT BLEEDS.

THE WEFT-FLUID
STILL FLOWS,
AS IF THE WORLD
ITSELF REMEMBERS
ITS PURPOSE...

LOOK AT
THE SIZE
OF THIS
PLACE...

IT'S
BEAUTIFUL...

...AND
TERRIFYING.

THOSE CHAINS...
THEY'RE STILL
MOVING.

LIKE
SOMETHING
DOWN HERE
IS STILL
ALIVE.

ガラン
KLANG

THIS ISN'T
JUST AN
ANCHOR...

IT'S THE
HEART OF
THE OLD
WORLD.

WEFT-FLUID.

THE LIFELOOD
OF GA-EARTH.

KEEPER OF
THE PAST.

PRISON OF
THE FORGOTTEN.

THE FALLING ANCHOR.

DEPTH: 1.7 KM
STATUS: **UNSTABLE**
GRAVITY: NONE
DIRECTION: DOWN

HOLD FAST.

RUST
FLAKES. THIRD
RIB. PUSHING
OFF.

KRRCH

RIB THREE.
MICRO-CORROSION
THIN SPOT. BEST
VECTOR IS—

WAIT.

TIK
TIK
TIK

HA! THAT'S
ONE WAY TO
SAY "IT'S GONNA
BREAK."

HOLD
TIGHT, BIX!

CHAIN TENSION
IS COMPROMISED.
GEAR SIX TOOTH
SHEAR IMMINENT.

WE CUT
THROUGH THE
SPINDLE OR WE
GET PINNED.

COPY THAT!

Renn—arc left
of the counterweight.
Sloane—gear six.
I'll mark the safe
thread.

WATCH THE
SWAY!

FOCUS.

BREATHE.

GRINDDD

THREAD
NARROWS IN
THREE...

TIK
TIK
TIK

TWO!

ONE!

NOW!

THWIP!

KRAAANGG!

DELICATE.
ISN'T IT?



SLOANE--
WATCH
OUT!



MOVE.



I'VE
GOT
YOU.

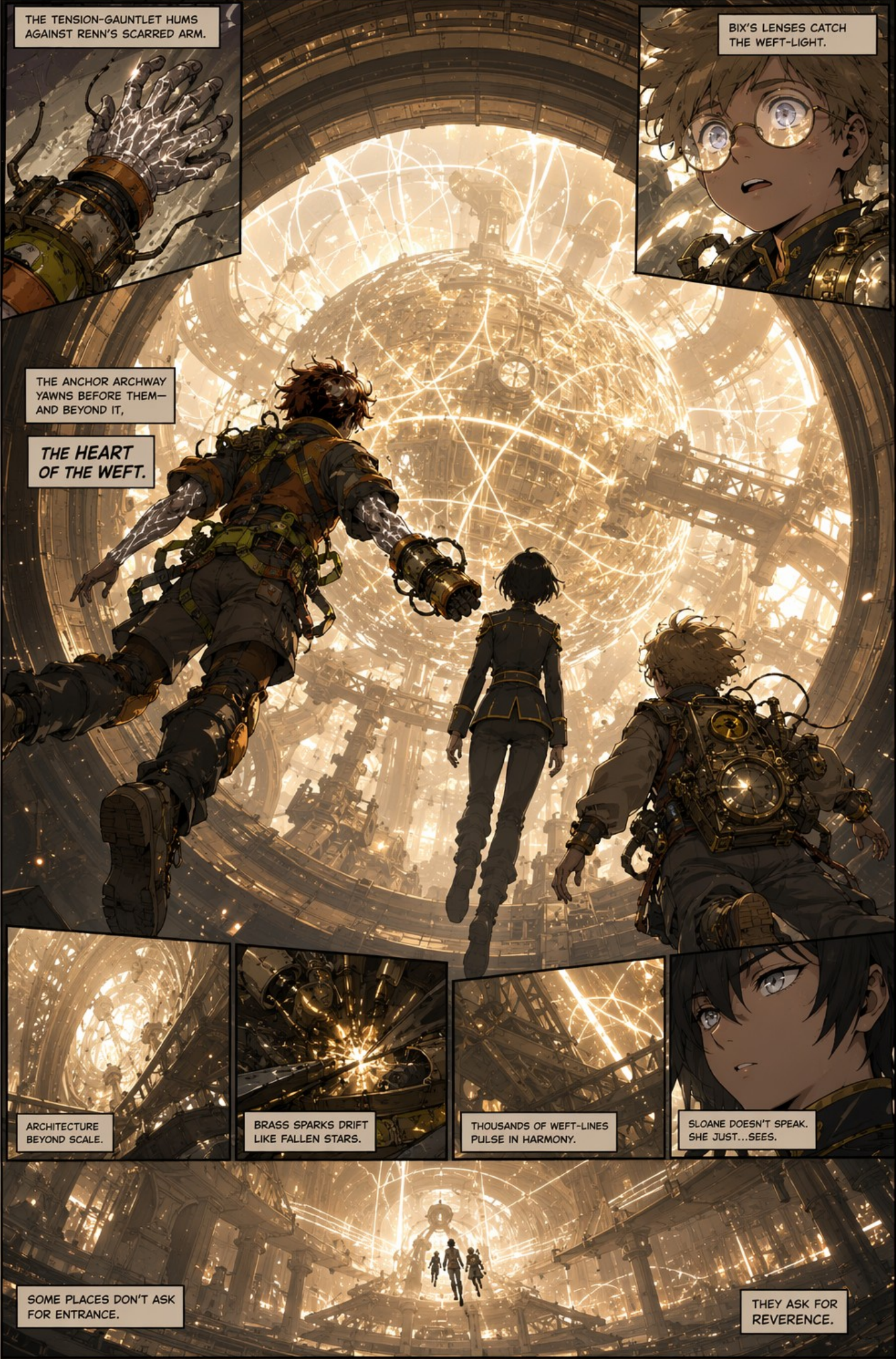
AH--!



TENSION
SPIKING--!

CABLE
SNAP--





THE TENSION-GAUNTLET HUMS
AGAINST RENN'S SCARRED ARM.

BIX'S LENSES CATCH
THE WEFT-LIGHT.

THE ANCHOR ARCHWAY
YAWNS BEFORE THEM—
AND BEYOND IT,

**THE HEART
OF THE WEFT.**

ARCHITECTURE
BEYOND SCALE.

BRASS SPARKS DRIFT
LIKE FALLEN STARS.

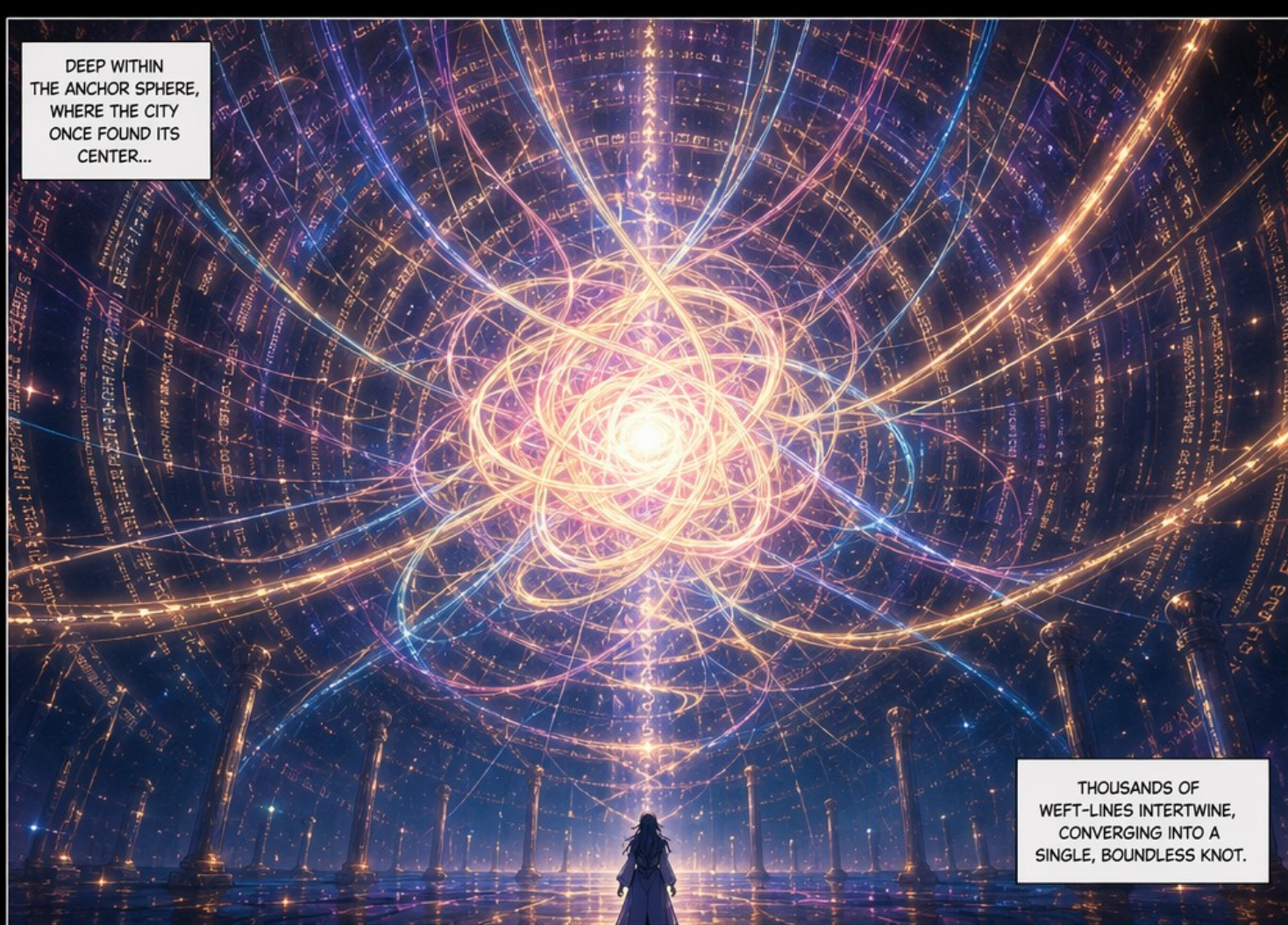
THOUSANDS OF WEFT-LINES
PULSE IN HARMONY.

SLOANE DOESN'T SPEAK.
SHE JUST...SEES.

SOME PLACES DON'T ASK
FOR ENTRANCE.

THEY ASK FOR
REVERENCE.

DEEP WITHIN
THE ANCHOR SPHERE,
WHERE THE CITY
ONCE FOUND ITS
CENTER...



THOUSANDS OF
WEFT-LINES INTERTWINE,
CONVERGING INTO A
SINGLE, BOUNDLESS KNOT.

SO THIS IS
THE HEART
OF THE CITY...



THE WALLS OF THE SPHERE
PULSE WITH ANCIENT LIGHT,
RECORDING EVERY THREAD OF
FATE WOVEN INTO EXISTENCE.



BEFORE,
THE KNOT
HELD ALL
THINGS IN
HARMONY.



NOW...
ITS LIGHT
FLICKERS.

THE WEFT-LINES
REMEMBER.



THE CITY
FALLS.

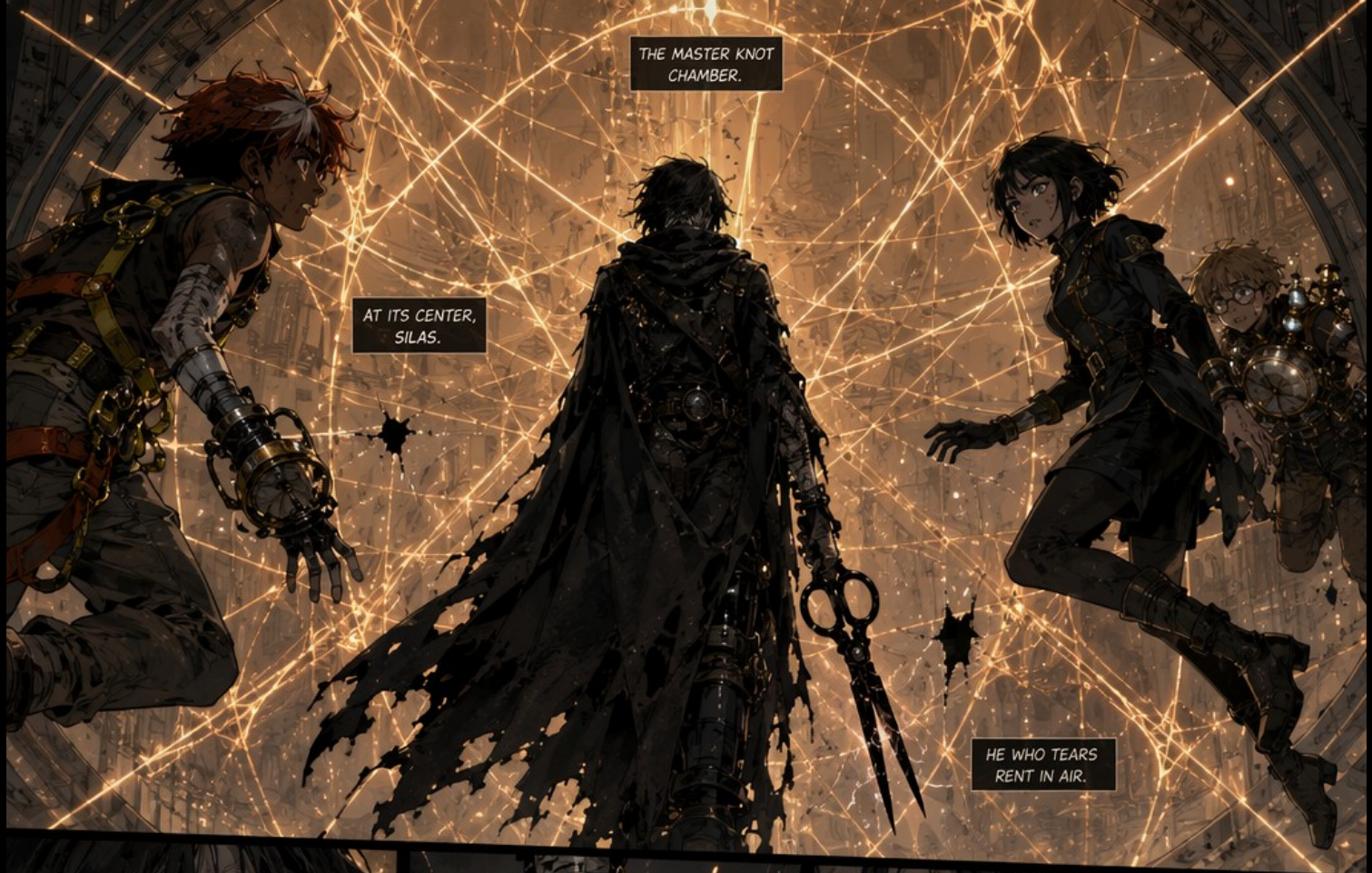


IF THE KNOT
UNRAVELS...
THEN SO DOES
EVERYTHING.



TO HOLD THE KNOT
IS TO HOLD FATE ITSELF.

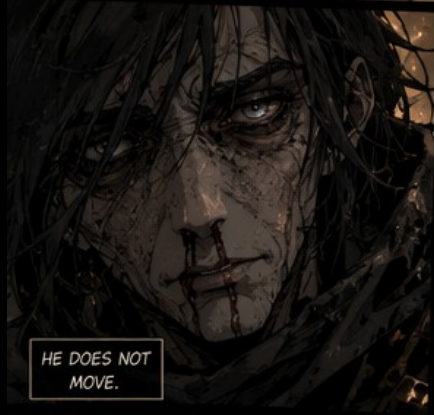
— END CHAPTER 47 —



THE MASTER KNOT
CHAMBER.

AT ITS CENTER,
SILAS.

HE WHO TEARS
RENT IN AIR.



HE DOES NOT
MOVE.



HE DOES NOT
NEED TO.



HE IS THE
STILL POINT.



AND WE ARE
THE DRIFT.



RENN.

YOU PULL AGAINST
THE KNOT.

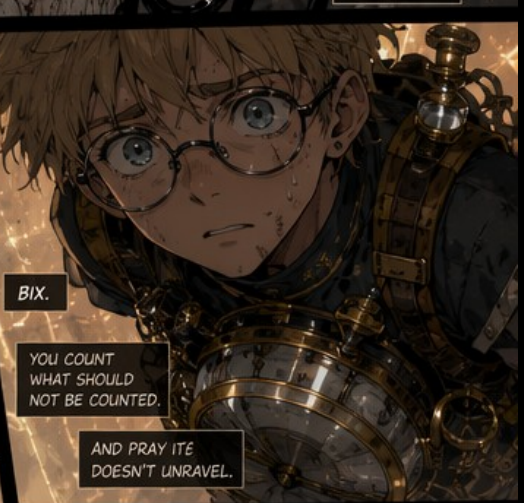
BRAVERY, OR
STUPIDITY?



SLOANE.

YOU WEAR NONE
OF THEIR MARKS
NOW.

AND STILL YOU
STAND.



BIX.

YOU COUNT
WHAT SHOULD
NOT BE COUNTED.

AND PRAY IT
DOESN'T UNRAVEL.



SILENT SMILE.

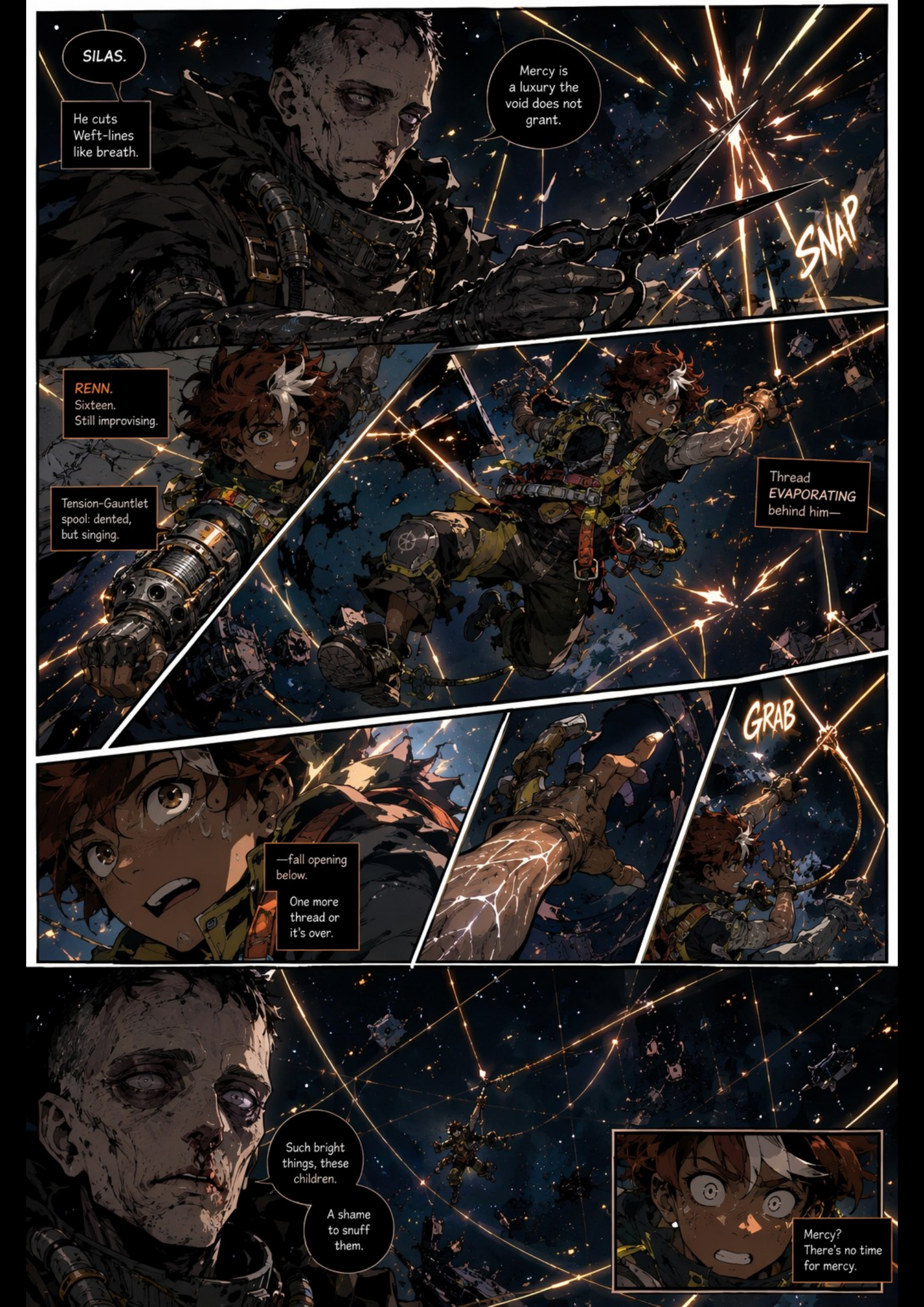
LIKE A PROMISE
ALREADY KEPT.



WELCOME, CHILDREN.

TO THE CENTER OF
EVERYTHING THAT
HOLDS.

AND THE PLACE
WHERE IT ALL
COMES APART.



SILAS.

He cuts
Weft-lines
like breath.

Mercy is
a luxury the
void does not
grant.

SNAP

RENN.
Sixteen.
Still improvising.

Tension-Gauntlet
spool: dented,
but singing.

Thread
EVAPORATING
behind him—

GRAB

—fall opening
below.

One more
thread or
it's over.

Such bright
things, these
children.

A shame
to snuff
them.

Mercy?
There's no time
for mercy.

SLOANE.
SIXTEEN.

VANGUARD
CADET.
RANK
INSIGNIA
REMOVED.

WEFT-LINE.
FROZEN ON
COMMAND.

SILAS.
THIRTY-SOMETHING.
EX-HAILER.
NOW, MERCY
MADE FLESH.

VOID-BLACK SHEARS.
TEAR THE AIR.
UNMAKE MERCY.

KRRRNCH

KRAK

SHATTER

WHA—

ORDER.
MADE
STEEL.

HE THOUGHT
MERCY WOULD
CUT ANYTHING.

TODAY,
HE LEARNED
ITS LIMIT.

WEFT HOLDS. MERCY BREAKS.

HEH--!

YOU'RE
FAST.

BUT
THREAD'S
FASTER.

GET OUT OF
MY WAY, KID--!

THESE
SHEARS CUT
NOTHING--

TENSION
CALIBRATION--
HIGH-HIGH-HIGH!

--EXCEPT
FAILURE!

AH--!

CHAOTIC WEAVE
MODE: IMPROVISE!

NGH...!?



SILAS.

THIRTY-TWO CYCLES.
COUNTLESS FAILURES.

THIS ISN'T
SALVATION.

THE WEFT-LINE.

SPINE OF THE FALSE
PATTERN.

IF I CUT IT,
REALITY
UNRAVELS.
EVERYTHING
UNMAKES.

JUST
MERCY.

THE LAST
THREADS
BINDING
THIS LIE—

I CUT.

GOOD.
LET IT END.

I WAS NEVER
MADE TO
WEAVE.

I WAS MADE
TO END
WHAT SHOULD
NEVER HAVE
BEEN WOVEN.

FORGIVE ME.
OR DON'T.

I'M
CUTTING
ANYWAY.

RENT THE WEFT.
UNMAKE THE LIE.
BE FREE.

SILAS

The Weft holds because they believe it should.

I merely remind it—

ZENITH SHEARS:
VOID-EDGED. REALITY-SEVERING.

SHHHRRRAAKK

SILAS. AGE 33.
EX-GRAVITY DIVER
ZENITH SHEAR OPERATIVE
STATUS: **INFECTED**

WEFT-LINE:
PRIMARY LOAD-BEARING
HARMONIC ANCHOR.

SEVERED.

—that it
need not.

TREMBLE

RENN!

BIX—
GET DOWN!

TIK
TIK
TIK
TIK

RENN. AGE 16.
WEFT-RIGGER
TEN-GAUNTLET: MARK II
RIGHT ARM: ASCENDED SCAR

BIX. AGE 14.
FREQUENCY ANALYST
CHRONO-RESONANT PACK
STATUS: **OVERLOADED**

ON IT.

KRAAANG!

SLOANE. AGE 16.
VANGUARD CADET
VAULT-PIKE: ISSUE ZERO
RANK: **STRIPPED**

SLOANE DEFLECTED
78.4 TONS OF FALLING
GRAVITYWORKS AT
2.7 SECONDS TO IMPACT.

CADENCE. DISCIPLINE.
PRECISION.

THAT IS HOW WORLDS
ARE SAVED.

SLOANE.
VANGUARD CADET.
SIXTEEN.
RANK INSIGNIA
REMOVED.

DEFLECT.

SILAS.
THIRTY-ONE.
GAUNT. TREMBLING.
MISTAKES DESTRUCTION
FOR MERCY.

THE WEFT
DOES NOT FORGIVE
INTERFERENCE.

VOID-BLACK SHEARS.
TEAR THE AIR.
RENT REALITY.

WEFT-LINE
SEVERED.

KRIK
KIKK

TENSION
SEEKS
EQUILIBRIUM.

RRRIP

PLATE FAILURE.
INITIATED.

KNNCH

WHHOOOM

TANG!

SKRAAANK!

KRRRMMBELL!

MERCY...

FINALLY...
MERCY...

RECOIL.
NOT AN ATTACK.
A CONSEQUENCE.



THE MASTER KNOT
IS UNRAVELED.

ITS SONG CUT
TO SILENCE.

SILAS...

...WHO SOUGHT FREEDOM
IN THE UNMAKING.

HE FOUND IT.

THE CHAMBER
FALTENCE.

WITH EACH CUT,
HE UNRAVELED MORE
THAN THREAD.

THE THREADS DIM.

HE UNRAVELED
HIMSELF.

THE KNOT LOSES
ITS LIGHT.

AND WITH THE
LAST RENT—

AND SILAS...

...VANISHES.

THE VOID REMEMBERS.

END OF EPISODE

TO BE CONTINUED...